

Java vs Python

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Version: 1.0

Date: Jan 6, 2026

Introduction

This document compares Java and Python, two widely used programming languages. Both languages are versatile and powerful. The comparison covers the following aspects:

1. Syntax differences
2. Common use cases
3. Performance

Overview of Java

Java is an object-oriented programming language. James Gosling and his team invented Java in the early 1990s at Sun Microsystems. Java is widely used for building large-scale enterprise applications. Some of the key features of Java are:

1. Supports static types
2. Source code compilation
3. Supports object-oriented programming
4. Built-in automatic memory management
5. Built-in security features
6. Moderate learning curve
7. Fast runtime performance
8. Concurrency support
9. Large library ecosystem

Overview of Python

Python is an interpreted language. It was invented by Guido von Rossum in 1989. Python is used by data scientists, web developers, researchers, and academicians. Some of the key features of Python are:

1. Supports dynamic types
2. Interpreted code
3. Supports object-oriented programming
4. Built-in memory management
5. Built-in security features

6. Short learning curve
7. Compact coding
8. Concurrency support (Global Interpreter Lock)
9. Large ecosystem of packages for data science, machine learning, web development, and research

Syntax differences

Java and Python differ in code syntax conventions.

Static vs dynamic typing

Java supports static typing, i.e., types are determined at compile time. A type must be specified for every variable when declared. The declared type and the value are verified at program compile time. Once a variable is bound to a specific data type, it is fixed. The type cannot be modified.

```
// Main.java

public class Main
{
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        int age = 55;
        float temperature = 100.3f;
        double weight = 110.25d;
        boolean is_visible = true;
        String name = "John Doe";
    }
}
```

Python supports dynamic typing, i.e., types are determined at run time. Type checking occurs at program run time. The same variable can store multiple data types.

```
# main.py

age = 55
temperature = 100.3
is_visible = True
name = "John Doe"
```

Indentation rules

In Java, code is usually indented using 2 to 4 leading spaces. In Python, code is indented using 4 leading spaces. Python uses indentation to define code blocks.

```
// Main.java

public class Main
{
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        int x = 2;
        int y = 3;
        int z = x + y;
        System.out.println("x="+x+",y="+y+",z="+z);
    }
}
```

Statement termination

In Java, statements end with a semicolon (;).

In contrast, Python statements do not end with a specific character, such as a semicolon.

Defining code blocks

In Java, code blocks begin with a curly brace and end with a curly brace.

In Python, there are no curly braces surrounding code blocks. Line indentation determines a code block.

Importing modules

In Java, libraries are imported using import statements at the beginning of the program. To import a specific class, specify the full path to the class in the import statement (See `java.util.ArrayList` and `java.util.Vector` in the code snippet below). To import all packages in a library, the wildcard `*` is used (See `java.lang.Math.*` in the code snippet below).

```
// Main.java
import java.lang.Math.*;
import java.util.ArrayList;

public class Main
{
    public static void main(String[] args) {

        double x = 3.14;
```

```

        System.out.println("square root of x = "+Math.sqrt(x));

        ArrayList<Integer> arrayList = new ArrayList<>();
        arrayList.add(Integer.valueOf(1));
        System.out.println(arrayList);
    }
}

```

In Python, external modules are imported using **import** and/or **from** at the beginning of the file. To import an entire module, use the import module statement. To import a specific class from a module, use the from module import class statement.

```

# main.py

import math
print("pi = ",math.pi)

from math import pi
print("pi = ",pi)

```

Common use cases

Java is used to develop:

1. Large-scale enterprise applications
2. Android applications
3. System programs involving concurrency and multi-threading
4. Applications requiring high-performance at scale

Python is used to develop:

1. Data science applications
2. Machine learning algorithms
3. Artificial intelligence applications
4. Web applications
5. Research and academic applications

Performance

There are differences in performance between Java and Python.

1. Java is a compiled language, whereas Python is an interpreted language (except for CPython, which is compiled).
2. Java code is compiled to bytecode that executes fast.
With Python, the code is interpreted and executed line by line.
3. Python's dynamic typing makes the language very flexible, but results in a performance drop at runtime.

This makes the overall execution of Java programs faster for CPU-intensive workloads, whereas Python programs score higher in faster development time and readability.

Summary

The table below is a quick summary of the similarities and differences between Java and Python.

Number	Aspect	Java	Python
1	Type of programming language	Object-oriented programming language	Object-oriented programming language
2	Learning curve	Moderate	Short
3	Syntax	Verbose	Compact
4	Type checking	Static, compile-time	Dynamic, run-time
5	Security	Bytecode verification at runtime	Runtime checks
6	Programming paradigms supported	Object-oriented programming, procedural programming	Object-oriented programming, procedural programming, functional programming
7	Use cases	Enterprise applications High-performance systems	Data science Machine learning Artificial intelligence
8	Concurrency	Threads and semaphores	Global interpreter lock
9	Runtime performance	Faster for CPU-intensive workloads	Slower for CPU-intensive workloads

References

DataCamp. **Python vs Java: Differences and Similarities in 9 Key Areas.**

<https://www.datacamp.com/blog/python-vs-java>